SHAME-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Possible repair and its limits

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Explore whether a particular action is the person's responsibility and whether a limited, safe, respectful repair is suitable. The outcome may also be choosing not to contact someone or continuing professional assessment.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not force apology, confession, compensation, or renewed contact. Do not address harm done by another through blaming the harmed person. The sheet does not decide legal, religious, or diagnostic questions, or support repetitions seeking certainty that everything is forgiven.

Reusing existing material

After distinctions in SHAME-02 and respectful self-regard in SHAME-03, explore concrete responsibility. REG-05 addresses conflict repair; here, also examine the boundary between shame and a real need for repair.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Gal returned a borrowed item late. He chooses to acknowledge the delay and arrange its return without repeatedly messaging to check that the other person is not angry.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What practical responsibility needs clarification in this situation?

2 | Question for discussion

Is repair needed, or am I seeking repeated reassurance?

3 | Question for discussion

What limited action is possible and safe?

4 | Question for discussion

What boundaries and consent of the other person must be respected?

5 | Question for discussion

How will we end the trial without demanding an outcome from them?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If there is no clear action and the urge is to confess to feel safe, assess the pattern professionally. Do not create another repair action to silence doubt.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

An adult helps distinguish an action from a label about the child. There is no forced public apology, humiliation, or responsibility for the other's reaction; choose a small everyday situation.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Check social, family, or online pressure before contact. Wording can be practiced without sending it; posting an apology or personal details is not required.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore practical consequences and power differences. This form does not replace suitable legal or professional advice and does not determine an obligation to compensate.

OA | Older adults

Respect a decision not to renew contact or revisit the past. Present-day repair or clarification alone may be chosen, without urgency based on age.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Any contact or action needs discussion and adaptation with the therapist. Sending a message, paying, disclosing information, or making contact is not required; planning alone is an alternative.

At the next session

Review fit, boundaries, and learning, not receipt of forgiveness. Difficult feelings may remain after responsible action or a choice not to act.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/tips-and-support/raise-low-self-esteem/
www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/lifes-challenges/maintaining-healthy-relationships-and-mental-wellbeing/

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